ST. JOSEPH'S INSTITUTION INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

IGCSE SUBJECT OPTIONS HANDBOOK 2027/2028

WELCOME TO SJI INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

Introduction

Welcome to the Year 9 Subject Options Handbook. This booklet aims to give details of the IGCSE courses available to students entering Year 10 in August 2027. Students will follow the core subjects, English Language (First or Second Language), English Literature or Media Studies, Mathematics and Science. They can then select optional choices from the groups presented later in this document.

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Your Dreams and Aspiration

You are about to make the most important decision of your school life so far. At the start of Year 10 you will begin the courses that will result in you gaining your first set of official qualifications. These qualifications will move you onto the next steps in achieving your DREAMS and ASPIRATIONS in life. At SJIIS, we want to help you to develop into a well rounded individual who has the skills, qualities and character to contribute positively to the future world. This includes completing Year 11 with the best set of qualifications you can before moving into the Sixth Form. We will work as hard as possible with you to help you to reach your goals. Carefully considering the information in this handbook is the next stage in that process, as it will help you to choose the right subjects for your future. It is important that you get these decisions right and that is why we believe that these choices should be discussed fully between you, your parents and your teachers.

Don't forget that the qualifications that you gain, whilst important, represent only one aspect of you as a person. It is important that you continue to develop your character over the coming years. It is important that you continue to attend CCAs, and take every opportunity to contribute to the school community in any way that you can. You will want your resume or CV to be as broad as possible as you make the next steps in your life.

How will this booklet help me?

Choosing subjects and qualifications to study in Years 10 and 11 can seem daunting. Do not panic. There is a lot of information and advice available to help you choose which options are right for you.

This handbook contains the information you need to know about the subjects you can choose to study in Years 10 and 11.

What sort of person am I?

To help you decide what to study in Years 10 and 11, start by asking yourself what you enjoy doing and what you are good at.

Think about:

- What are you interested in: it could be other cultures and languages, writing projects, helping people, being outdoors or designing things?
- What types of activity do you enjoy most: working things out and thinking them through, practical activities or artistic options like painting, drawing or performing music?
- What you are like at home, as well as in school. What skills have you developed following outside interests?

Having reliable information is the key to making successful choices. Make sure that you allow yourself enough time to research your career ideas, option choices and possible progression routes before selecting your IGCSE subjects. Speak to your tutor and your subject teachers if you need clarification on their subject areas.

Questions you should ask yourself before you decide on your subjects:

- How will my IGCSEs affect my future?
- If I choose not to take a particular subject at IGCSE, can I still do that subject at A Level?
- What do I want to do when I finish the course?
- Do I like the subject?
- Am I good at it?
- Will my course choices keep my future options open?
- Do I know what the course will involve?
- Have I done enough research to be sure of my choices?

Questions you should <u>not</u> be considering before you decide on your subjects:

- Is it a suitable subject for a girl/boy?
- Should I take the same IGCSE subjects as my friends?
- Will other people agree with my choices?
- Should I choose my IGCSEs based on my teachers?
- Will it be an easy subject to pass?

What subjects do I have to take?

The subjects that everyone studies are called CORE subjects. These are as follows:

Mathematics (0580) – IGCSE Mathematics (Additional Mathematics is available in the free choice options only to students who have **consistently performed at a grade B or above** in year 9 mathematics)

English First Language (0500) OR
English Second Language (0511) (Only for students enrolled in the EAL programme)

Block A: English block
English Literature (0475) OR
Media Studies (AQA 8572) - students will choose between IGCSE English Literature or IGCSE Media Studies.
English Language (0500/0511)
Compulsory for students studying English as a Second Language to sit in Y10/Y11 with the opportunity to move onto English First Language in Y11 if ready.

Block B & C: Science blocks (0654)

- Coordinated Science (2 grades)
  or
- All two choices from Biology (0610), Physics (0625) , and Chemistry (0620) (1 grade each)

(Students should be aware that both options will allow students to study the Sciences at A Level).
(Studying all 3 sciences is not recommended, however if you really love science and consistently perform well in all 3 sciences you have the option to use one of your free choices to take Physics in addition to Biology & Chemistry in blocks B&C)

Character and Wellbeing (this is a non-examined course)

Lasallian Education – (this is a non-examined course)

PE – Physical Education (this is a non-examined course)

BM - Bahasa Melayu (this is a non-examined course)

What options can I choose?

Free choice options

Here you will be able to choose **one option from each block.**

Block D:	Block E:	Block F:	Block G:
Chinese All levels	Art & Design	Music	Drama
Spanish Foreign Language	History	DT & Graphics	Computer Science
Business Studies	Computer Science	Geography	ICT
Psychology	PE	Psychology	Physics
Add. Math (Invite only)	Physics	Business Studies	Global Perspectives
	Add. Math (Invite only)	Bahasa Melayu Foreign Language	Economics
	ASDAN (Invite only)	Chinese Foreign Language	
		Add. Math (Invite only)	

Key Guidance & Advice

Avoid Overlapping Subjects: Taking both Business Studies and Economics is discouraged because their foundational concepts overlap heavily, limiting the variety of skills you show to future universities.

Balancing Your Options: Aim for a mix of assessment types—avoid picking four heavy essay/memorization subjects together (e.g., History + Psychology + English Lit + Geography) unless you excel at long-form writing. Pair an essay subject with a practical or computational subject to keep your workload balanced.

We would also advise students to add breadth to their curriculum choices by taking a Language, although for EAL students, other options may be more beneficial.

Plan strategically: To reach entry requirements for A-Levels generally speaking you need a minimum of 5 A*-C grades **including English Language** (3 to 4 of these will need to be at grade B or above in the subjects* you wish to study at A-Level)

*NB: A-Level Subjects can be selected without having taken them at GCSE, however a grade B or above in academically similar subjects will be desired.

In summary, choose subjects that keep the right doors open, develop your strengths and interests, and meet the entry requirements of any future courses you may be considering. GCSEs provide preparation, but universities generally place greater weight on relevant A-levels, IB subjects or equivalent post-16 qualifications.

How do I fill in my Subject Options Form?

This year, you will select your options online. You will receive a link to where you can make your choices following the IGCSE Options Evening on 24th November 2026

You must have selected your options by Friday 29th January 2027.

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CORE SUBJECTS AT SJIIS

MATHEMATICS

What will I learn and when?

Cambridge IGCSE Mathematics (0580) develops students' numerical, algebraic, geometrical and statistical skills. Students learn to apply mathematical knowledge to everyday situations, solve unfamiliar problems, reason logically and communicate their solutions clearly. The course provides a strong foundation for further study in mathematics and other subjects.

The course covers **nine main topic areas**: Number; Algebra and Graphs; Coordinate Geometry; Geometry; Mensuration; Trigonometry; Transformations and Vectors; Probability; and Statistics.

The following outline provides an indicative sequence for the standard two-year course. The order and pace may be adjusted to reflect students' progress and learning needs.

1st Year – Term 1:	Number, Algebra and Geometry
1st Year – Term 2:	Mensuration, Coordinate Geometry, Graphs and Functions
1st Year – Term 3:	Pythagoras' Theorem and Right-angled Trigonometry
2nd Year – Term 1:	Further Algebra, Functions, Sequences, Statistics and Probability
2nd Year – Term 2:	Further Trigonometry, Transformations and Vectors
2nd Year – Term 3:	Revision, consolidation and preparation for external examinations

Students normally sit the Cambridge IGCSE Mathematics examinations at the end of year 11 (June 2029). Students who have been invited into the accelerated pathway will sit IGCSE Mathematics in June 2028, followed by IGCSE Additional Mathematics (0606) in June 2029.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Mathematics (0580)

Skill Requirements

Throughout the course, students will develop skills in:

- Applying numerical and algebraic techniques accurately.
- Selecting suitable strategies to solve familiar and unfamiliar problems.
- Identifying patterns and connections between mathematical topics.
- Reasoning logically and justifying conclusions.
- Interpreting mathematical information presented in different forms.
- Communicating solutions clearly using appropriate notation and working.
- Calculating confidently both with and without a scientific calculator.

To be successful you should:

- Develop secure foundations in numeracy and algebra.
- Practise regularly and revisit previously learned topics.
- Look for connections between mathematical ideas and apply them in new situations.
- Show your working clearly and explain your reasoning.
- Ask questions, reflect on feedback and learn from mistakes.

- Become confident in using a scientific calculator appropriately, while continuing to strengthen your non-calculator skills.

How will I learn?

Students learn through teacher explanations, worked examples, individual practice, collaborative tasks, investigations and problem-solving activities. Lessons combine the development of core techniques with opportunities to apply these techniques in unfamiliar contexts.

Regular feedback and reflection help students identify areas for improvement and become increasingly independent learners.

How will I be assessed?

Students following the **Extended syllabus** take two externally assessed written examinations:

Examination	Duration	Marks	Weighting	Calculator requirements
Paper 2: Non-calculator (Extended)	2 hours	100	50%	Calculators are not permitted
Paper 4: Calculator (Extended)	2 hours	100	50%	A scientific calculator is required

Both papers contain structured and unstructured questions, and students must answer all questions. Extended candidates are eligible for grades A*–E.

Graphical and algebraic calculators are not permitted. There is no coursework component.

Throughout the course, classwork, homework and internal assessments will help students and teachers monitor progress and identify areas requiring further support.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Mathematics (Secondary): Mr Ananthan Seluerajah
Email: ananthan@sji-international.edu.my

ENGLISH FIRST LANGUAGE

What will I learn and when?

As the English First Language (0500) course is taught alongside the English Literature (0475) course **or** Media Studies (9257) course within English lessons, the topics that students cover will alternate between the two. However, whilst students might be working on English Literature or Media Studies material, opportunities to develop English language skills will also be included.

During Year 10 and Year 11, students will work on their coursework portfolios. Students will also complete tasks which are designed to develop skills relevant to the IGCSE exam which will take place at the end of Year 11.

1st Year - Term 1: Descriptive writing (coursework assignment) - students will plan and write a creative piece of writing in response to some suggested prompts

1st Year - Term 2: Narrative writing (coursework assignment) - students will plan and write a creative piece of writing in response to some suggested prompts

1st Year - Term 3: Preparation for Paper 1: Reading examination

2nd Year - Term 1:

- Argumentative/Persuasive writing (coursework assignment) - students will read a topical text and write a response to the author's ideas in which they explain their own opinions using the features of rhetoric
- Preparation for Paper 1: Reading examination

2nd Year - Term 2: Revision and exam preparation

2nd Year - Term 3: Revision and exam preparation

As well as this, students will look at a range of fiction/non-fiction texts to help with their understanding and appreciation of language and style in different forms.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE First Language English (0500)

Skill Requirements

Cambridge IGCSE First Language English is designed for learners whose mother tongue is English or who have a level of proficiency which allows them to competently access the course. The course allows learners to:

- Develop the ability to communicate clearly, accurately and effectively when speaking and writing;
- Learn how to use a wide range of vocabulary, and the correct grammar, spelling and punctuation to communicate ideas effectively;

- Develop a personal style and the awareness of the audience being addressed.

Learners are also encouraged to read widely, both for their own enjoyment and to further their awareness of the ways in which English can be used. The course also develops more general analysis and communication skills such as inference and the ability to order facts and present opinions effectively.

How will I learn?

In English lessons, a range of learning strategies will be used in order to encourage students to work both independently and collaboratively. These will include essay writing, presentations, group tasks, class discussions, self-assessment and peer assessment.

To be successful you should:

- Have a passion for the process of writing.
- Be a keen student of fiction and able to learn from masters of the craft of creative writing.
- Possess a keen attention to detail.
- Understand the need to draft and edit written work and view this as part of the creative process.
- Be able to meet deadlines and manage work and time accordingly.

How will I be assessed?

Assessment for IGCSE English First Language will comprise of an examination and a coursework portfolio of three assignments.

Students will take:

Paper 2: Reading Passages (Extended) - Candidates answer three questions on two passages. This component is eligible for grades A - G and is worth 50% of the total marks.

And

Component 4: Coursework Portfolio - Candidates submit three assignments, each of 500 - 800 words. This component is eligible for grades A - G and is worth 50% of the total marks.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Department: Jack Cartwright
Email: jackcartwright@sji-international.edu.my

ENGLISH AS A SECOND LANGUAGE

What will I learn and when?

The English as a Second Language (0511) course is available to students who have participated in the EAL pathway programme in Year 9. This course develops skills for understanding and communicating in a range of situations in English. These skills include the ability to understand written and spoken texts, and selecting relevant information from them. This information may be directly stated or implied. Students develop the linguistic skills required for progression to further studies or employment through being able to communicate clearly in writing and speaking, on both familiar and less familiar topics.

During Year 10 and Year 11, students will complete tasks which are designed to develop skills relevant to the IGCSE exam which will take place at the end of Year 11*. (*In individual cases, there may be the opportunity to take the exam early in Year 10 and progress onto the English First Language course if the student is able to make sufficient progress).

The order and format of how the syllabus is taught will depend on the individual needs of the cohort and may vary year to year.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE English as a Second Language (0511)

Skill Requirements

Cambridge IGCSE English as a Second Language is designed for students whose mother tongue is a language other than English. The course allows students to:

• develop their ability to use English effectively for the purpose of practical communication
• develop their awareness of the nature of language and language-learning skills
• develop transferable skills to complement other areas of the curriculum
• promote their personal development and enjoyment.

Students are also encouraged to read widely, both for their own enjoyment and to further their awareness of the ways in which English can be used. The course also develops more general analysis and communication skills such as inference and the ability to order facts and present opinions effectively.

How will I learn?

In English lessons, a range of learning strategies will be used in order to encourage students to work both independently and collaboratively. These will include essay writing, presentations, group tasks, class discussions, self-assessment and peer assessment.

To be successful you should:

- Have an interest in developing all aspects of effective communication.
- Be keen to use language creatively.
- Possess a keen attention to detail.
- Not be afraid to step out of your comfort zone and view this as part of the learning process.
- Be able to meet deadlines and plan work and time accordingly.

How will I be assessed?

Assessment for IGCSE English as a Second Language will consist of three examinations.

Students will take:

Paper 1: Reading & Writing - 50%

Candidates respond to six exercises: four reading and two writing, in structured and essay style questions. This is externally assessed.

Paper 2: Listening - 25%
Candidates listen to five exercises of short and longer texts and answer multiple-choice style questions. This is externally assessed.

Paper 3: Speaking 25%
Candidates take part in an interview, short talk and discussion. This is internally assessed and externally moderated.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Department: Rebecca Merrett
Email: rebeccamerrett@sji-international.edu.my

LITERATURE IN ENGLISH

What will I learn and when?
In IGCSE Literature in English (0475), students will study a range of texts in preparation for the IGCSE examinations at the end of Year 11. Reading material will include a play, a novel and an anthology of poetry. This course will be taught alongside the English First Language (0500) course.

1st Year - Term 1: Poetry (set text). Students will explore a range of poems from the poetry anthology. They will revise the techniques and skills that are essential to the course by practising close analysis and will be assessed via practice exam responses.

1st Year - Term 2: Prose (set text). Students will study a novel and further refine their essay writing skills.

1st Year - Term 3: Revision of Poetry and Prose texts for end of year exams.

2nd Year - Term 1: Drama (set text). Students will study a play. As this is a set text, students will also be tested on this in the IGCSE examination.

2nd Year - Term 2: Poetry (set text). Students will study the remaining part of the poetry anthology by exploring a selection of poems.

2nd Year - Terms 2 & 3: Revision and exam preparation

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Literature in English (0475)

Skill Requirements

Cambridge IGCSE Literature (English) aims to develop learners who:

- Enjoy the experience of reading literature;
- Understand and respond analytically to literary texts in different forms and from different periods and cultures;
- Communicate an informed personal response appropriately and effectively;
- Appreciate different ways in which writers achieve their effects;
- Experience literature's contribution to aesthetic, imaginative and intellectual growth;
- Explore the contribution of literature to an understanding of areas of human concern.

How will I learn?

In English lessons, a range of learning strategies will be used in order to encourage students to work both independently and collaboratively. These will include essay writing, presentations, group tasks, class discussions, self-assessment and peer assessment.

To be successful you should:

- Have a passion for literature and reading beyond the text.
- Be comfortable with various viewpoints and beliefs and view discussion as a tool to further your understanding.
- Be comfortable with ambiguity.
- Be prepared to learn to think critically and with perception.
- Be able to meet deadlines and plan work and time accordingly.

How will I be assessed?

Assessment for IGCSE Literature in English will comprise of an examination and a coursework portfolio of two assignments.

Students will take:

- Component 1: Poetry and Prose - Candidates answer **two** questions on **two** texts. This component is worth 50% of the total marks.
- Component 3: Drama (Open Book) - Candidates answer **one** question on **one** text. This component is worth 25% of the total marks.
- Component 4: Unseen - Candidates answer **one** question on **one** text. This component is worth 25% of the total marks.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Department: Jack Cartwright
Email: jackcartwright@sji-international.edu.my

MEDIA STUDIES

What will I learn and when?

The IGCSE Media Studies course is offered as an alternative to Literature and is taught alongside the First Language English course. The topics that students cover will alternate between English Language and Media Studies. However, whilst students might be working on other English material, opportunities to develop media literacy and analytical skills will also be included.

Throughout Year 10 and Year 11, students will complete analytical work on a range of set texts and practical tasks that develop the creative and critical skills required for the course. Students will also complete a Non-Exam Assessment (NEA) project which contributes to their final grade.

1st Year – Term 1: Introduction to the media and key concepts: media language, representation, audiences and industries. Study of selected Set Media Products (SMPs) across print and online media.

1st Year – Term 2: Analysis of television, advertising and marketing texts. Practical production skills – introduction to media design and digital tools.

1st Year – Term 3: Completion of their Non-examination Assessment (NEA). Preparation for the Media One paper through mock-style questions and review of exam techniques.

2nd Year – Term 1: Completion of study of outstanding SMPs and preparation for examination skills.

2nd Year – Term 2: Preparation for Paper 1: Media One – revisiting advertising, magazines and online/social media CSPs.

2nd Year – Term 3: Preparation for Paper 2: Media Two – television and newspaper analysis. Final revision and examination preparation.

Students will explore a range of media forms including film, television, advertising, video games, radio, magazines, newspapers and online/social media, developing their understanding of how meanings are created and communicated to audiences.

Specification Name and Number

AQA Media Studies (8572)

Skill Requirements

AQA IGCSE Media Studies is designed for learners who have a keen interest in the media and its role in society. The course allows learners to:

- Develop their ability to analyse and interpret a wide range of media texts.
- Understand how media products are constructed through language, representation and technical features.
- Explore how audiences respond to and interact with media in different ways.
- Learn about the key industries that produce and distribute media content.
- Apply theoretical concepts to their own creative media production.

Students are encouraged to think critically about media influence, to engage with current issues in communication and technology, and to apply creative skills to real-world contexts.

How will I learn?

In Media Studies lessons, students will take part in a wide variety of activities designed to encourage both independent and collaborative work. These will include textual analysis, research projects, debates, presentations, creative production, peer assessment and reflective evaluation.

To be successful you should:

- Be curious about how media shapes our understanding of the world.
- Enjoy analysing films, adverts, social media or magazines in depth.
- Be creative and interested in producing your own media texts.
- Be able to plan, research and meet coursework deadlines.
- Be open to developing both written and practical skills using digital tools.

How will I be assessed?

Assessment for IGCSE Media Studies will comprise of one written examinations and one Non-Exam Assessment (coursework project):

Paper 1: 3 components exploring SMPs studied throughout the course and how audiences respond to these texts. Worth 50% of the qualification

Non-Exam Assessment (NEA): Creating a Media Product – Students research, plan and produce an original media product for a specified audience in response to an annually released AQA brief. Includes a 1000-word reflection. Worth 50% of the IGCSE.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Department: Jack Cartwright
Email: jackcartwright@sji-international.edu.my

SCIENCE

Skill Requirements

The IGCSE Science Programmes enable students to:

- Better understand the technological world in which they live, and take an informed interest in science and scientific developments.
- Learn about the basic principles of science through a mix of theoretical and practical studies.
- Develop an understanding of the scientific skills essential for further study and which are useful in everyday life.
- Learn how science is studied and practised, and become aware that the results of scientific research can have both good and bad effects on individuals, communities, and the environment.

To be successful you should:

- You should try to apply the content in class to the world around you or bring real-life examples into the class to further your understanding.
- You should understand that the scientific method is not a direct path but a series of questions and analysis that is used with critical reflective thinking.
- You should be willing to ask questions so that you can analyse data and information to deepen your understanding of concepts and principles.
- You should look beyond memorising a set of facts and work towards using information in new situations.

I. COORDINATED SCIENCE

Students who complete the Coordinated Science programme will attain two (averaged) IGCSE grades (i.e. A*A* or BB), for all three Sciences. Coordinated Science creates a clear pathway to any of the A Level.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Coordinated Science (0654)
2029 Specification: 0654 Coordinated Science 2028-2029 Specs

How will I learn?

Styles of learning: Experimentation, Mind Maps, Independent Work, Group Work.

Practical Workbook: There will be a range of different practical activities that we will do in all three Sciences. Some of these experiments and their techniques will be tested in your exams.

Websites: Cambridge Website, BBC Bitesize, Save My Exams.

Revision: As well as the revision sessions led by teachers, you will be guided to revision materials on BBC Bitesize and given lots of exam style questions in lessons and before your exams.

How will I be assessed?

All students that opt to study the Coordinated Science programme, will be externally assessed at the end of Year 11. Upon completion, they will attain two IGCSE grades for Science.

There are three externally assessed examinations, which will be sat in May/June of Year 11. The first paper is based upon multiple choice, with the second being based on short answers and structured questions. There is also a third paper based on practical skills.

Each exam will contain content from the Biology, Chemistry and Physics criteria; which can be found in the Coordinated Science (0654) specification.

There is no internal assessment associated with this programme of study. Your grades depend exclusively on your external assessment.

II. **SINGLE SCIENCES**

Instead of opting for Coordinated Science, students may opt to study two or three individual Sciences: Biology, Physics and Chemistry. Students will be awarded separate IGCSEs in each. This pathway can also lead to the study of any of the Sciences at A Level.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Biology (0610)

Specification: 0610 Biology 2026-28 Specs

Cambridge: IGCSE Chemistry (0620)

Specification: 0620 Chemistry 2026-28 Specs

Cambridge: IGCSE Physics (0625)

Specification: 0625 Physics 2026-28 Specs

How will I learn?

Styles of learning: Experimentation, Mind Maps, Independent Work, Group Work.

Practical Workbook: There will be a range of different practical activities that we will do in all three Sciences. Some of these experiments and their techniques will be tested in your exams.

Websites: Cambridge Website, BBC Bitesize, Save My Exams.

Revision: As well as the revision sessions led by teachers, you will be guided to revision materials on BBC Bitesize and given lots of exam style questions in lessons and before your exams.

How will I be assessed?

All students that opt to study the Individual Sciences programme, will be externally assessed at the end of Year 11. Upon completion, they will attain independent IGCSE grades for Biology, Chemistry and Physics.

There are three externally assessed examinations, which will be sat in May/June of Year 11. The first paper is based upon multiple choice, with the second being based on short answers and structured questions. There is also a third paper based on practical skills.

Each exam will contain content from the Biology, Chemistry and Physics criteria; which can be found in the Biology, Chemistry and Physics (0610, 0620, 0625) specifications.

There is no internal assessment associated with this programme of study. Your grades depend exclusively on your external assessment.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Department: Mrs Margaret Walsh
Email: margaretwalsh@sji-international.edu.my

PHYSICAL EDUCATION (NON-EXAMINED)

What will I learn and when?

Physical Education in Year 10 is of a recreational nature and will consist of predominantly practical sessions. SJIIS recognizes that physical activity is linked to emotional wellbeing and academic performance. Apart from the associated health benefits, it is also a means of releasing tension and aiding relaxation. Physical Education classes will access an array of sporting facilities at SJIIS including our Multi-Purpose Hall (MPH), Football field and Dance studio.

Course Content: A variety of team games and striking sports including Ultimate Frisbee, Volleyball, Basketball, Touch Rugby, Badminton, Netball, Rounders and Minor Games. Year 10 Physical Education students may also have the opportunity to enhance and practice Sports Leadership within their lessons.

Skill Requirements

- Active participation in all lessons.
- FULL SJIIS PE UNIFORM – EVERY LESSON. This also applies if you are unwell or unable to participate physically- you will still be expected to bring your PE uniform and participate in the lesson in a different way.

How will I learn?

Styles of learning: Through active participation and practically through coaching, officiating and leadership activities.

How will I be assessed?

Although **this is not an examined course**, you will be assessed in class by your teacher, predominantly on your active participation, leadership and performance in class. *Please see IGCSE PE for more information on PE as an examined course.*

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Physical Education: James Regan
E-mail: jamesregan@sji-international.edu.my

PERSONAL, SOCIAL, HEALTH AND CHARACTER EDUCATION (NON-EXAMINED)

What will I learn?

Students will develop five core social and emotional competencies:

Self-awareness – Understanding emotions, strengths, and values, and how they shape behaviour.

Self-management – Managing emotions, setting goals, and staying motivated under different situations.

Social awareness – Understanding and empathizing with others from different backgrounds and cultures.

Relationship skills – Building positive relationships, communicating clearly, resolving conflicts, and working collaboratively.

Responsible decision-making – Making ethical, safe, and thoughtful choices for ownself and wider community.

How will I learn?

Students will learn through reflection, discussions, teamwork, and real-life practice with their tutors. Activities may include role plays, group projects, self-assessments, and guided exercises that help students apply emotional and social skills in everyday school and community settings.

How will I be assessed?

Assessment will focus on how students demonstrate these skills in action, through participation, collaboration, reflection journals, and feedback from teachers and peers. Growth in self-awareness, relationships, and responsible choices will be key indicators of progress.

What does 'Personal, Social, Health and Character Education' develop and why is it useful?

Students will gain greater emotional intelligence, confidence, empathy, and resilience. These skills will help you build stronger relationships, make better decisions, and succeed both personally and academically, preparing students to contribute positively to your community and future workplace.

Who should I contact for further information?

Assistant Principal: Character and Wellbeing: Mrs Jasmine Sabharwal

Email: jasminesabharwal@sji-international.edu.my

LASALLIAN EDUCATION
(NON-EXAMINED)

What will I learn and when?

This course invites you to explore the three core Lasallian Values—Faith, Service, and Community—alongside the five Lasallian Principles: Faith in the Presence of God, Concern for the Poor and Social Justice, Quality Education, Respect for All Persons, and Inclusive Community. These values and principles will be examined within the context of an increasingly globalized and interdependent world, highlighting their relevance in today's society.

Faith

- **Beliefs and Values** – Reflecting on personal identity and one's value system
- **Human Dignity** – Recognizing the inherent goodness and uniqueness of every person

Community

- **Inclusive Community** – Fostering community cohesion and interfaith dialogue
- **Lasallian for Life** – Strengthening commitment to the Lasallian community, now and in the future
- **Social Justice** – Exploring social issues through the lens of Lasallian spirituality and philosophy

Service

- **Wider Service** – Understanding the UN Sustainable Development Goals and their impact
- **School Community Service Project** – Engaging in acts of service with a focus on concern for the poor and social justice

How will I learn?

You will engage in enquiry-based learning, encouraging you to explore social realities, ask meaningful questions, and seek thoughtful answers. The course will challenge you to develop confidence in speaking and listening through debates, public speaking, and presentations. You will be introduced to reflection models and frameworks that will support both personal and academic growth. Additionally, you will learn practical ways to plan, implement, and evaluate service initiatives, ensuring meaningful and continuous improvement throughout the learning process. Assessment will be ongoing, based on participation, reflection, and engagement—this is not an examined course.

What does Lasallian Education develop and why is it useful?

Lasallian Education fosters a deeper understanding of social realities, values, spirituality, religion, beliefs, culture, and community. It contributes to spiritual, emotional, intellectual, social, and cultural growth, aligning with our school ethos. Through this course, you will have the opportunity to build character, internalize Lasallian values, and live out our school motto: "Enter to Learn, Leave to Serve."

Who should I contact for further information?

LEDU teacher: Brother Mico de Leon FSC and Brother Butch Alcudia FSC
Email: brmico@sji-international.edu.my; brbutch@sji-international.edu.my

BAHASA MELAYU
(NON-EXAMINED)

What will I learn and when?

Bahasa Melayu is the national language of Malaysia and a common language root of the national language in regional countries surrounding Malaysia (Singapore, Indonesia and Brunei). This course provides Malaysian students with an opportunity to develop fluency and good proficiency in their home country's language.

The department has designed approaches to enrich the learning of Malay language, standardising grammar usage and developing an appreciation for the language as well as cultural understanding. Incorporating history, folklore, traditional games and the cultures to the designated topics as part of the work plan, it is the objective of this course that every student is equipped with language proficiency as well as develop a deep appreciation for the melting pot of cultures in Malaysia.

1st Year

Term 1 - Travelling
Term 2 - Malaysian Festivals
Term 3 - Occupation

2nd Year

Term 1 - Accommodation
Term 2 - Entertainment

How will I learn?

Experiential and discovery learning are the key features. Students will be led and facilitated to apply the language theories and formulas that are taught into their tasks and assignments. Students' interests and strengths will be harnessed and a student-centred strategy is adopted in enriching their language learning. Students are taught to take ownership of their learning in developing an awareness of how they are progressing and to apply what they have learnt in their daily context.

How will I be assessed?

You will be assessed in class by your teacher, although this is not an externally examined course.

OPTIONS SUBJECTS AT SJIIS

BAHASA MELAYU FOREIGN LANGUAGE IGCSE

What Will I Learn and When?

Cambridge IGCSE Foreign Language Malay is designed for learners who are learning Malay as a foreign language. The aim is to develop an ability to use the language effectively for practical communication. The course is based on the linked language skills of listening, reading, speaking and writing, and these are built on as learners progress through their studies.

The syllabus also aims to offer insights into the culture and civilisation of Malaysia, thus encouraging positive attitudes towards language learning and towards speakers of foreign languages.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Malay (0546)

Skill Requirements

Learning Malay foreign comes with 4 objectives:

- Understand and respond to spoken language
- Understand and respond to written language
- Communicate in speech, showing knowledge of a range and variety of vocabulary, and applying the grammar and structures of the target language accurately
- Communicate in writing, showing knowledge of a range and variety of vocabulary, and applying the grammar and structures of the target language accurately

How will I be assessed?

Assessment for IGCSE qualification in Malay is comprised of three parts in the form of 4 separate examination papers (Papers 1, 2, 4, and 3):

- Paper 1 Listening (25% of the final grade) - Candidates listen to a number of recordings and answer questions testing comprehension.
- Paper 2: Reading (25% of the final grade) - Candidates are to read a number of texts and answer questions, testing comprehension.
- Paper 3: Speaking (25% of the final grade) – Candidates complete one role play and conversations on two topics.
- Paper 4: Writing (25% of the final grade) – Candidates complete one form-filling task, one directed writing task and one task in the format of an email/letter or article/blog.

To be successful you should:

- Be able to communicate proficiently at basic Malay language level.
- Be equipped with the foundation in Malay grammar and syntax.
- Be equipped with the necessary skills at the basic level in oral communication.
- Understand and be aware that Malay is the national language of Malaysia and the surrounding neighbouring countries.
- Be able to understand and appreciate the cultural context of the Malay language.
- Understand the importance of using Malay language in daily speech contexts in improving your language proficiency.

PLEASE NOTE: This qualification is **NOT** equivalent to the SPM Bahasa Malaysia exam.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Languages: Ms Ying Ying Tan

Email: yingying@sji-international.edu.my

SPANISH

What will I learn and when?

The specification for IGCSE Spanish gives students the opportunity to develop lifelong skills including the ability to effectively use another language as a means of practical communication; gain insight and have a positive attitude towards learning a foreign country's language, its culture and its civilisation; provide intellectual stimulation that enhances memory and analysis; and develop a sound foundation for progression to employment or further study.

The course is studied as 5 units (topic areas*). The course is linear and students will be entered for all 5 units (topic areas) at the end of Year 11.

During Year 10 you will complete projects to support and give you the skills for your controlled assessment; this will run alongside your learning topics for your exam.

Specification Name and Number

IGCSE Spanish - 0530

Skill Requirements

Students will demonstrate effective communication in a foreign language by re-enacting different scenarios that cover a broad range of everyday topics. You will explore the culture and the civilization of the foreign country applying the language being studied, utilizing what you have learnt to further appreciate learning about your surroundings.

How will I learn?

Learning Spanish comes with 4 objectives:

- Understand and respond to spoken language
- Understand and respond to written language
- Communicate in speech, showing knowledge of a range and variety of vocabulary, and applying the grammar and structures of the target language accurately
- Communicate in writing, showing knowledge of a range and variety of vocabulary, and applying the grammar and structures of the target language accurately

How will I be assessed?

Assessment for IGCSE qualification in Spanish is comprised of four parts in the form of 4 separate examination papers (Papers 1, 2, 3 and 4):

Paper 1 Listening (25% of the final grade) - Candidates listen to a number of recordings and answer questions testing comprehension

Paper 2 Reading (25% of the final grade) – Candidates read a number of texts and answer questions testing comprehension

Paper 3 Speaking (25% of the final grade) – Candidates complete one role play, 2 topics conversation (1-2) together.

Paper 4 Writing (25% of the final grade) - Candidates respond in the target language to the three tasks

Content overview

The subject content is organised in five broad topic areas* (listed below). These provide contexts for the acquisition of vocabulary and the study of grammar and structures. The study of these topic areas enables students to gain an insight into countries and communities where Spanish is spoken.

1. Everyday activities
2. Personal and social life
3. The world around us

4. The world of work
5. The international world

Students will be expected to read and understand a range of written and spoken content on familiar subjects. They will be required to understand the core ideas, perspectives, and feelings, identify relevant specifics, and deduce the meanings of occasional unfamiliar terms using context. Moreover, they'll have chances to write in Spanish about everyday topics. Engaging in day-to-day conversations and interactions is vital, emphasising the importance of interaction in the language learning process.

To be successful you should

- You have a genuine interest in Spanish.
- You are not afraid to 'have a go' and are not worried about making mistakes.
- You realise that learning a language can take time, and you need to be determined to succeed. You don't let small setbacks stop you.
- You are self motivated and practise your skills regularly.
- You are willing to listen to your peers and learn from and with them.

Curriculum changes

- The lessons will be more interactive and participating.
- Classroom games and use of technology wll be implemented in class.
- Group discussions will be organised as well as presentations.
- Students will be working in groups and they will be assigned each a task or role.
- Listening exercises will be practised on a regular basis to get used to different pronunciation and situations.
- Roleplay practice will be part of the component to develop in class.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Languages: Ms Ying Ying Tan
Email: yingying@sji-international.edu.my

CHINESE - FIRST LANGUAGE

What will I learn and when?
The Cambridge IGCSE First Language Chinese (0509) is designed for learners whose first language is Chinese. The syllabus develops learners' ability to communicate clearly, accurately and effectively.

Cambridge IGCSE First Language Chinese offers candidates the opportunity to respond knowledgeably to a range of reading passages. Candidates will use some of these passages to inform and inspire their own writing and write in a range of text types for different audiences. The passages cover a range of genres and types, including fiction and non-fiction, as well as Classical Chinese texts, and may also include other forms of writing, such as essays, reviews and articles. Learners will have the opportunity to read Classical Chinese prose texts to help to deepen their knowledge of Chinese culture.

In Year 10, you will start to develop your skills in reading, writing, critical thinking and literary analysis. You will learn to think critically and reflect on what you read and/ or view to become critical readers and viewers, and deepen your understanding and appreciation of Chinese culture and classical texts. You will also develop your skills and strategies for writing. In Year 11, you will continue to develop your skills to understand, explain and collate implicit meanings and attitudes of a writer in order to help you to analyse and evaluate the contexts. You will also continue to learn to construct descriptive, narrative and argumentative/discursive tasks using a variety of well-made sentences, including sophisticated complex sentences. You will be gaining lifelong skills including: the ability to communicate clearly, accurately and effectively in speaking and writing; and the ability to use a wide range of vocabulary and correct grammar, character formation and punctuation in this course.

External exams are set by Cambridge International Examinations and students sit the exams in Term 3 of Year 11.

Specification Name and Number
Cambridge IGCSE First Language Chinese (0509)

Skill Requirements
The course encourages learners to develop lifelong skills including:

- The ability to communicate clearly, accurately and effectively in writing;
- The ability to use a wide range of vocabulary and correct grammar, character formation and punctuation;
- A personal style and an awareness of the audience being addressed.

How will I learn?
Learning First Language Chinese comes in a variety of different methods, from individual work to whole class discussion; from reading comprehension to essay writing. Throughout the syllabus, learners will learn to appreciate the language, analysing, synthesising and inferencing the text which then to use the knowledge to improve and inform their writings. Apart from that, learners will also learn to appreciate Chinese culture and have a deeper understanding of the classical texts.

How will I be assessed?
Assessment for IGCSE qualification in First Language Chinese is comprised of two parts in the form of 2 separate examination papers (Papers 1 and 2):

- Paper 1 Reading, Directed Writing and Classical Chinese (50% of the final grade) – candidates answer a series of comprehension questions based on Passage 1; and answer one compulsory question on two thematically linked nonfiction passages - Passage 2 and 3; and answer a series of questions about Passage 4, a previously unseen passage of Classical Chinese text.
- Paper 2 Writing (50% of the final grade) – candidates write two compositions of 400–600 characters: Section 1 Argumentative/Discursive Writing; and Section 2 Descriptive/Narrative Writing.

To be successful you should:

- You have a genuine interest in Chinese culture and Chinese Language.
- Be able to analyse different types of articles to foster your understanding.
- Be prepared to read widely, including classical texts, both for your own enjoyment and to further your awareness of the

ways in which Chinese can be used.
- Be prepared to work with information and ideas in Chinese by developing skills of critical evaluation, analysis, synthesis and inference.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Languages: Ms Ying Ying Tan

Email: yingying@sji-international.edu.my

CHINESE - SECOND LANGUAGE

Cambridge IGCSE Chinese as a Second Language (0523) is accepted by universities and employers as proof of linguistic ability and understanding.

The course is organised around 4 broad topic areas which provide contexts for the acquisition of vocabulary and the study of grammar and structures.

The following sequencing will be used during the 2-years course:

1st Year - Term 1: A.Young people and education; B. Society
1st Year – Term 2: C. The World
1st Year – Term 3: D. Cultural Society
2nd Year – Term 1: E. Preparation for speaking examination
2nd Year – Term 2: Preparation for external examinations

External exams are set by Cambridge International Examinations and students sit the exams in Term 3 of Year 11.

Specification name and number
Cambridge IGCSE Chinese as a Second Language (0523)

Skill requirements
The course encourages learners to:

- Develop the ability to use Chinese effectively for the purpose of practical communication.
- Form a sound foundation for the skills required for further study or employment using Chinese as medium.
- Understand what is implied but not directly stated, e.g. writer's purpose, intention and feelings.

How will I learn?
From individual, pairs, small groups to whole class discussion, learners learn the four skills (listening, speaking, reading and writing) through exploring the topics which will enable them to communicate effectively for the purpose of practical communication using the Chinese language. Apart from the knowledge, learners will also gain insight into the cultures of countries and communities where Chinese is spoken.

How will I be assessed?
For Cambridge IGCSE Chinese as a Second Language, all candidates take Papers 1, 2 and 3, and are eligible for the award of grades A* to G.

- Paper 1 Reading & Writing (60% of the final grade) – Written examination consisting of five exercises that test a range of reading and writing skills
- Paper 2 Listening (20% of the final grade) – Written examination consisting of four exercises that test listening skill.
- Paper 3 Speaking (20% of the final grade) – Speaking examination in which candidates complete a topic presentation, a topic conversation and a general conversation.

To be successful you should:

- **Set a proper timetable for your study**: Allocate at least 45-minute a day for revision or exploring new knowledge in different tasks: vocabulary, grammar next, essay etc.
- **Learn grammar if you don't already know it**: Grammar is the skeleton of a language, its basic structure, you must learn it.
- **Develop a good attitude**: Have a clear personal reason for taking the subject. Set personal goals for what you want to learn.
- **Get help if you need it**: Talk with your teacher. Form study groups among class members.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Languages: Ms Ying Ying Tan
Email: yingying@sji-international.edu.my

FOREIGN LANGUAGE Chinese CHINESE

What will I learn and when?

Cambridge IGCSE Chinese Chinese- Foreign Language (0547) is accepted by universities and employers as proof of linguistic ability and understanding.

The course is organised around several topic areas which provide contexts for the acquisition of vocabulary and the study of grammar and structures.

The following sequencing will be followed throughout the two-year course:

1st Year - Term 1: A. Everyday activities; B. Personal and social life;
1st Year – Term 2: C. The world around us
1st Year – Term 3: D. The world of work
2nd Year – Term 1: E. The international world; Preparation for speaking examination
2nd Year – Term 2: Preparation for speaking examination

External exams are set by Cambridge International Examinations, and students sit these exams in Term 3 of Year 11. The internal exam refers to the speaking examination, which takes place in Term 2 of Year 11 and is conducted by the school teachers.

Specification Name and Number
Cambridge IGCSE Chinese Chinese- Foreign Language (0547)

Skill Requirements
The course encourages learners to develop lifelong skills, including:

- Develop the ability to use Chinese effectively for the purpose of practical communication.
- Form a sound foundation for the skills required for further study or employment using Chinese as medium.
- Develop transferable skills (e.g. memorising, drawing of inferences) to complement other areas of the curriculum.

How will I learn?
From individual, pairs, small groups to whole class discussion, learners learn the four skills (listening, speaking, reading and writing) through exploring the topics which will enable them to communicate everyday needs using the Chinese language. Apart from the knowledge, learners will also gain insight into the cultures of countries and communities where Chinese is spoken.

How will I be assessed?
Assessment for IGCSE qualification in Chinese is comprised of four parts in the form of 4 separate examination papers (Papers 1, 2, 3 and 4):

- Paper 1 Listening (25% of the final grade) – candidates listen to a series of recordings and answer questions that assess their comprehension skills.
- Paper 2 Reading (25% of the final grade) – candidates read a variety of texts and respond to questions that evaluate their understanding.
- Paper 3 Speaking (25% of the final grade) – candidates complete one role play, two topic conversations.
- Paper 4 Writing (25% of the final grade) - candidates respond in the target language to the three tasks.

To be successful you should

- You have a genuine interest in learning Chinese.
- You are not afraid to 'have a go' and are not worried about making mistakes.
- You are self motivated and practise your skills regularly.
- You are willing to listen to your peers and learn from and with them.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Languages: Ms Ying Ying Tan
Email: yingying@sji-international.edu.my

ECONOMICS

What will I learn and when?

The two-year course comprises six sections as follows:

- Basic Economic Problem: Choice and the allocation of resources.
- The Allocation of Resources: How the market works, market failure (demand, supply and price, how resources are allocated, how markets fail).
- Microeconomic decision makers: households, firms, banks, firms' production, costs and revenues, market structures
- Government and the Macroeconomy: Aims of government, monetary policy, fiscal policy, supply-side policy, unemployment, inflation, economic growth.
- Economic Development: Poverty, population, living standards, differences between countries.
- International Aspects: Specialisation and free trade, globalisation and trade restrictions, exchange rates, balance of payments.

The first 3 sections will be covered in Year 10 and the remaining sections 4-6 will be covered in Year 11.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Economics (0455)

Skill Requirements

Throughout the course the students will acquire the following skills:

- The ability to apply the tools of economic analysis.
- The ability to distinguish between facts and value judgements in global issues.
- An understanding of, and an ability to use, basic economic numeracy and literacy.
- The ability to take a greater part in decision-making processes in everyday life.
- An understanding of the economies of developed and developing nations.

To be successful you should:

- Have basic mathematical aptitude.
- Be comfortable interpreting graphs, charts, and diagrams.
- Be good at understanding complex models. Economics is a subject which looks at complex systems. You'll need to be able to integrate information from different sources and different fields in order to be able to work with these complex systems.
- Be comfortable with uncertainty. You will need to be comfortable with uncertainty, as not every question in this field has a clear and unambiguous answer.

How will I learn?

Success in Economics requires the student to be able to apply economic knowledge and understanding in written, numerical, diagrammatic and graphical form thus all these skills must be practised throughout the two year course. You will develop them in a number of ways: whole class instruction; working individually, in pairs or in small groups using textbook and online research sites, practice of drawing relevant diagrams along with student presentations and class discussions.

How will I be assessed?

The assessment has two components,
Paper 1: Multiple choice (1 hour, 40 questions, 40 marks, 30% of total marks)
Paper 2: Structured questions (2 hours, one compulsory question Section A and then choice of three questions from four Section B, 80 marks, 70% of total marks)
Candidates must take both papers. Candidates receive grades from A* to G.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Department: Miss Sarah Smith
Email: sarahsmith@sji-international.edu.my

BUSINESS

What will I learn and when?

The study of this course comprises six sections:

- Understanding business activity
- People in business
- Marketing
- Operations management
- Financial information and decisions
- External influences on business activity

By the end of Year 10, the first three sections will be completed and the study of Operations Management will have started. This, and the remaining two sections of the syllabus, will be completed in Year 11 leaving time for revision of all material before the final IGCSE examination.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Business 0264

Skill Requirements

Through this course students will gain lifelong skills, such as:

- The ability to calculate and interpret business data
- Communication skills needed to support arguments with reasons
- The ability to analyse business situations and reach decisions or judgements.

How will I learn?

A range of learning techniques will be employed for the successful completion of this course. Students will learn to work both independently and collaboratively in deriving and calculating data. They will engage in role play and presentations for the Management and Marketing sections of the syllabus and they will make use of case study materials in developing their skills of analysis and evaluation.

To be successful you should:

- Work logically, clearly and precisely.
- Be able to apply your knowledge to solve problems.
- Analyse/evaluate your work and make improvements.
- Have good levels of writing and comprehension skills.
- Show mathematical reasoning skills.

How will I be assessed?

The assessment of this course comprises two papers:
Paper 1: 50% of total marks. Four questions requiring a mixture of short answers and structured data responses. Candidates answer all questions. (1 hour 30 minutes.)
Paper 2: 50% of total marks. Four questions based on a case study, provided as an insert with the paper. Candidates answer all questions. (1 hour 30 minutes)

Candidates must take both papers. Candidates receive grades from A* to G.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Department: Miss Sarah Smith
Email: sarahsmith@sji-international.edu.my

HISTORY

What will I learn and when?

History is a discipline far removed from merely memorising dates and names, but rather is concerned with thinking critically about the past in a balanced, reasoned way. In the IGCSE course we will primarily be concerned with studying many of the significant events of the 20th Century, a period marked by much conflict and violence. Through an examination of various source material and media, students will develop an enriched understanding of how the recent past shaped the world of today.

During Year 10 you will complete part of the core theme (The 20th Century: International relations since 1919) and the Depth Study (The Second World War in Europe and the Asia-Pacific, 1939-c. 1945). In Yr 11 you will complete the core theme and consolidate your understanding to prepare for your examinations.

1st Year Term 1: Core Theme: The Treaty of Versailles 1919-23, The League of Nations, The Collapse of International Order in the 1930s.
1st Year Term 2 : Depth Study: World War Two in Europe and the Pacific
1st Year Term 3: Depth study: World War Two in Europe and the Pacific
2nd Year Term 1: Core theme: The origins of the Cold War 1945-49.
2nd Year Term 2: Core theme: US policy of containment in Korea, Cuba, and Vietnam. USSR control of Eastern Europe 1948-89.

Specification Name and Number

IGCSE Cambridge History (0470)

Skill Requirements

By the end of the course you will be required to demonstrate an understanding of the significant events of 20th Century history, as well as an in-depth understanding of World War Two in Europe and the Pacific. You will also be required to read a variety of short historical sources, and compare, contrast, and analyse these sources to assess their value in understanding various historical events or policies. You will also need to be able to articulate your understanding of course content through active participation in class discussions.

How will I learn?

You will learn by reading historical texts, watching historical documentaries, watching historical films, constructing historical arguments, analysing historical sources, engaging in class discussions and formal debates, and participating, on occasion, in historical role-play activities.

To be successful you should:

- Be prepared to work hard, get involved with the subject, and take an interest in the past and different cultures.
- Be interested in causes and consequences of historical events, the significance of individuals and the way societies have changed over time.
- Tackle extended writing independently and enjoy developing lines of argument about the past.
- Be able to analyse historical sources and explain why they are useful to historians in their enquiries.
- Be prepared to do a good deal of reading and writing.

How will I be assessed?

Paper 1: Written paper on Core and Depth studies - 2 hours: 40%
Paper 2: Written sourcework paper on Core studies - 1 hour 45 mins: 30%
Paper 4: Alternative to Coursework - 1 hour: 30%

The final IGCSE grade will be determined by your performance on two externally assessed exams - Paper 1 and Paper 2 - plus the internally assessed coursework essay. The grade you will receive on your SJIIS report card throughout the course is based on a variety of assessments that help you foster the skills required to be successful in both papers. Students should expect two assessments per term in Year 10.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Department: Miss Sarah Smith
Email: sarahsmith@sji-international.edu.my

GEOGRAPHY

What will I learn and when?

The Cambridge IGCSE Geography course encourages students to develop curiosity and a fascination with the world around them. It gives students the opportunity to gain an understanding of the processes which affect physical and human environments, as well as a strong sense of their place and space in the world. The course covers a range of units on both human and physical geography in order to build an understanding of how communities around the world are affected and constrained by different environments.

The units are studied as follows:

- Changing river environments
- Changing coastal environments
- Changing ecosystems
- Tectonic hazards
- Climate change
- Changing populations
- Changing towns and cities
- Development
- Changing economies
- Resource provision.

Across the two year program, you will study all the above units, as well as coursework/paper 4 and exam revision.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Geography (0460)

Skill Requirements

Geography requires learners to demonstrate an ability to read and understand large volumes of text in the form of chapters, articles, explanations and case studies. You will need to be able to draw conclusions from diagrams, figures, and graphs, and express their meanings. The coursework component will require you to undertake fieldwork, gather data, and formulate conclusions in response to an identified issue, question, or problem related to the chosen focus. Paper two will also require students to demonstrate basic map-reading skills, basic mathematical concepts, and the ability to interpret sets of geographical data.

How will I learn?

You will be required to demonstrate your knowledge and skills in a variety of ways, including (but not limited to) drawing knowledge from whole class and small group discussion, and analysis of graphs, tables, diagrams, and case studies. Research will oftentimes need to be undertaken for small information reports, and in-class tests. Source material and case studies are collated in the Cambridge-based Geography textbook which is used both in class, and for homework tasks.

To be successful you should:

- Be prepared to work hard, get involved with the subject, and take an active interest in the world around you.
- Be interested in a range of human, physical and environmental Geography topics and keep up to date with real world events to provide a context to your case studies.
- Be able to research independently and as part of a team, and not be afraid to push to the limits of your abilities in order to challenge yourself for the top grades.

How will I be assessed?

Summative, class-based assessment will form the evidence for your report-grades in Years 10 and 11. Year 11 will also be when you complete your mock papers and Cambridge exams. The syllabus offers a choice - based on teacher judgement - between coursework and Paper 4, Alternative to Coursework. Both the coursework and Paper 4 will require a field trip to practice geographical fieldwork and data collection techniques. You will be assessed as follows:

Paper 1 - Physical Geography - 1 hour & 45 minutes: 36%
Paper 2 - Human Geography - 1 hour & 45 minutes: 36%
Paper 4 - Alternative to Coursework - 1 hour & 30 minutes: 28%

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Department: Miss Sarah Smith
Email: sarahsmith@sji-international.edu.my

GLOBAL PERSPECTIVES

What will I learn and when?

Cambridge IGCSE Global Perspectives (0457) develops students' ability to explore significant issues facing the world today and to consider these from personal, local/national, and global perspectives. The course helps students build essential transferable skills such as critical thinking, research, analysis, reflection, communication and collaboration. These skills support learning across all subjects and prepare students for future study and active citizenship.

Rather than focusing on content knowledge, the subject provides a framework for investigating *issues* within twenty-three broad topics, such as Climate Change, Digital World, Education for All, Migration, Health and Wellbeing, Globalisation, Poverty and Inequality and more . Students engage with real-world problems, evaluate different viewpoints, propose evidence-based courses of action, and reflect on their own perspectives.

1st Year – Term 1

Building foundations in perspectives, research, enquiry, evidence and communication.
Students explore Identity and Culture and Researching Global Issues, developing skills in analysing global issues, conducting guided research, evaluating evidence and considering different perspectives.

1st Year – Term 2

Developing critical evaluation and collaborative enquiry through Sustainability and Development and Collaborative Solutions. Students evaluate responses to global challenges, assess arguments and evidence, and develop collaboration and decision-making skills through practice Team Project activities.

1st Year – Term 3

Developing independent enquiry and preparing students for the Cambridge coursework components. Students explore Global Challenges before beginning the Independent Research Project, selecting a global issue, formulating a research question and beginning an independent investigation.

2nd Year – Term 1

Completion of the Independent Research Project and Cambridge Individual Report. Students then complete the Collaborative Action Project, focusing on teamwork, planning, action, presentation, evaluation and individual reflection.

2nd Year – Term 2

Developing advanced evaluation and judgement through Evaluating Global Perspectives. Students analyse sources, compare perspectives, evaluate arguments and evidence, and practise reaching balanced, justified judgements in preparation for Component 1.

2nd Year – Term 3

Examination preparation through Synoptic Global Perspectives. Students apply their learning to unfamiliar global issues, consolidate research, analysis and evaluation skills, and complete mock examination practice in readiness for the Cambridge Component 1 Written Examination.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Global Perspectives (0457)

Skill Requirements

Throughout the course, students will gain lifelong skills which include:

- Researching, analysing and evaluating information from diverse sources
- Developing and justifying a clear line of reasoning
- Understanding and comparing perspectives (local/national and global)
- Reflecting on how research and collaboration influence their own views and learning
- Communicating and collaborating effectively to achieve shared outcomes
- Proposing evidence-based courses of action in response to challenges

To be successful you should:

- Be curious about global issues and open-minded when considering different perspectives.
- Be prepared to explore articles, data, reports and personal testimony, and evaluate their credibility.
- Be reflective—think about how your own views change as you research and work with others.

- Contribute actively to team discussions and be willing to take initiative during collaborative action.
- Manage your time effectively when undertaking extended research tasks (Individual Report & Team Project).

How will I learn?

- Learning in Global Perspectives is highly interactive and student-centred. You will learn through:
- Investigation and enquiry using real-world sources
- Group discussion, debate and role play to explore multiple viewpoints
- Independent research leading to your Individual Report
- Collaboration when completing the Team Project
- Reflection on how your thinking changes through the learning process

Lessons involve analysing articles, videos, data sets, and case studies, and developing the skills needed to understand complex global issues.

How will I be assessed?

Assessment is based entirely on skills. All students complete three components:

- **Component 1** – Written Exam (35%) 1 hour 25 minutes
  Four compulsory questions based on source materials about a global issue from the topic list. Assesses analysis, evaluation, and judging the quality of evidence and actions.
- **Component 2** – Individual Report (30%) 1500–2000-word report
  Students choose a global issue of interest and investigate it from local/national and Global Perspectives. Assesses research, analysis, evaluation, reflection and communication.
- **Component 3** – Team Project (35%) Students work in teams of 2–5 to research a local issue linked to a global topic and carry out an action.
  Includes:
  - Explanation of Research and Planning (team)
  - Evidence of Action (team)
  - Reflective Paper (individual, 750–1000 words)
  - Assesses collaboration, communication, evaluation and reflection.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Department: Miss Sarah Smith
Email: sarahsmith@sji-international.edu.my

COMPUTER SCIENCE

What will I learn and when?

The IGCSE Computer Science course encourages students to develop computer-based solutions to problems using algorithms and a high-level programming language. They also develop a range of technical skills, as well as the ability to test effectively and to evaluate computing solutions. This qualification helps students to appreciate current and emerging computing technologies and the benefits of their use. They will learn to recognise the ethical issues and potential risks when using computers. Understanding the principles of Computer Science provides students with the underpinning knowledge required for many other subjects in science and engineering, and the skills learnt can also be used in everyday life.

Syllabus overview

The aims are to enable students to develop:

• computational thinking skills • an understanding of the main principles of solving problems using computers • the skills necessary to solve computer-based problems using a high-level programming language • an understanding of the component parts of computer systems and how they interrelate • an understanding of the internet as a means of communication and its associated risks • an understanding of the development and use of automated and emerging technologies.

Content

I) Computer systems

- Data representation: recognise the use of binary and hexadecimal systems.
- Data transmission: Understand how data is transmitted using a range of different transmission methods, be able to describe how data is encrypted using both symmetric and asymmetric encryption.
- Hardware and software: understand and describe logic gates, input devices, output devices, memory, storage devices and media, operating systems and high and low level languages.
- The Internet and its uses: show understanding of data transmission, Security aspects, Internet principles of operation.
- Automated and emerging technologies: Learn about the use of automated systems in context; explore how automated systems use sensors, robots, artificial intelligence,machine learning, and expert systems
- Algorithm design and problem-solving: work out how to use problem-solving and designing pseudocode and flowcharts.

II) Algorithms, programming and logic

- Programming: Learn programming languages such as Python; become familiar with programming concepts, data structures, arrays, flowcharts, pseudocode algorithms, debugging, testing, validation and verification methods
- Databases: Learn about the structure and components of databases; understand the type of data; understand the purpose of SQL scripts
- Boolean Logic: Understand the role and the function of each different logic gate;represent logic circuits; logic expressions;truth tables and problem statements;
- Programming Scenarios: Analyse problems to create programming solutions;understand how to tackle a large problem; identify the inputs,processes and outputs of a problem; use pseudocode or programming language such a Python to write solutions for problems

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Computer Science (0478)

Skill requirements

Computational thinking, that is thinking about what can be computed and how computers are used to solve problems, is an important aspect of this course. The ability and genuine interest in solving computer based problems independently using a high-level programming language Python, to support the development of students who decide to take the course, as well as the skills necessary to apply their understanding to solve computer-based problems using a high-level programming language.

To be successful you should:

- Think creatively, innovatively, analytically, logically and critically.
- Analyse problems in computational terms through practical experience of solving such problems, including designing, writing and debugging programs.
- Understand the components that make up digital systems, and how they communicate with one another and with other systems .
- Understand the impacts of digital technology to the individual and to wider society.
- Be able to apply mathematical and logical skills relevant to Computer Science.

How will I learn?

Computer science is a practical subject and a range of practical exercises is integral to the lessons delivered for this qualification. It is important that, as early as possible in the course, students develop a systematic approach to practical problem-solving using appropriate resources. Students will have experience of using a high-level programming language, such as Python, by the end of the two year course.

Assessment overview
All candidates take two components.

Paper 1: Computer Systems. 50% of total marks, short answer and structured questions. Questions will be based on Topics 1–6 of the subject content. Exam duration: 1 hour 45 minutes
Paper 2: Algorithms, Programming and Logic, 50% of total marks, short-answer and structured questions and a scenario-based question. Questions will be based on Topics 7–10 of the subject content. Exam duration: 1 hour 45 minutes

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Art, Design & Technology and Computer Science: Mrs. Fay Parker
Email address:fayparker@sji-international.edu.my

INFORMATION & COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY (ICT)

What will I learn and when?

The IGCSE Information and Communication Technology (ICT) course equips students with practical ICT skills and theoretical knowledge needed to navigate and utilise digital technologies effectively. It covers a broad range of ICT applications, including document production, data management, programming fundamentals, and website authoring. This course helps students develop an understanding of how ICT systems work, how they are used in different environments, and how to apply ICT safely and responsibly. The syllabus also emphasises problem-solving and critical thinking through practical and theoretical assessments.

Syllabus overview

The aims of this course are to enable students to:

- Develop a solid understanding of ICT systems, networks, and their applications.
- Gain the ability to analyse, design, implement, test, and evaluate ICT-based solutions.
- Recognise the impact of ICT in a technology-driven world and how it affects individuals and society.
- Understand data security and safe ICT practices.

Content

I. ICT Theory and Systems

- Types and Components of Computer Systems: Learn about hardware, software, and operating systems.
- Input and Output Devices: Understand the role and functions of input and output peripherals.
- Storage Devices and Media: Study different storage methods such as magnetic, optical, and solid-state storage.
- Networks and the Effects of Using Them: Explore networking principles, security risks, and cloud computing.
- The Effects of Using IT: Assess the impact of ICT on daily life, work, and health.
- ICT Applications: Investigate ICT applications in various fields such as communication, medicine, banking, and retail.
- The Systems Life Cycle: Learn how ICT systems are designed, implemented, and evaluated.
- Safety and Security: Identify threats such as hacking, phishing, and malware, and learn about data protection methods.
- Audience: Identify different types of users and understand their needs, preferences, and abilities when using ICT systems.
- Communication: Understand how ICT is used to share information and communicate effectively through emails, messaging, video calls, and other digital platforms.

II. Practical ICT Applications

- File Management: Understand file organisation and compression techniques.
- Images and Layout: Work with digital images, layouts, and formatting in ICT applications.
- Document Production: Develop skills in word processing, tables, styles, headers, and footers.
- Databases: Learn database structures, queries, forms, and reports using software such as SQL.
- Presentations: Create digital presentations using images, multimedia, animations, and hyperlinks.

III. Practical ICT Applications

- Spreadsheets: Work with formulas, functions, charts, and data models in spreadsheets.
- Website Authoring: Understand the basics of HTML, CSS, and website development.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Information and Communication Technology (0417)

Skill requirements

Information and Communication Technology (ICT) focuses on understanding how digital technologies are used to process,

manage, communicate, and present information effectively. Students develop practical skills in using a range of software applications, including word processing, spreadsheets, databases, presentations, and web authoring tools. The course develops students' ability to select and use appropriate ICT tools to solve real-world problems, analyse information, create digital solutions, and communicate effectively. Students also develop an understanding of the impact of ICT on individuals, organisations, and society, as well as the importance of data security, online safety, and responsible use of technology.

To be successful you should:

- Think critically and analytically when solving ICT-based problems.
- Understand and apply ICT tools in real-world scenarios.
- Be able to manage and manipulate data using ICT applications.
- Demonstrate safe and responsible ICT practices, including cybersecurity awareness.

How will I learn?

ICT is a practical subject, and students will engage in hands-on tasks that simulate real-world ICT applications. The course includes:

- Practical exercises using industry-standard software.
- Problem-solving tasks that require designing, testing, and refining ICT solutions.
- Real-world projects involving document production, database management, and website development.

By the end of the course, students will have hands-on experience in key ICT applications, equipping them with skills useful for further studies and employment.

Assessment overview

All candidates take three components.

Paper 1: Theory (40% of total marks) – 1 hour 30 minutes

- Short-answer and structured questions based on **all topics** of the syllabus.
- Examines theoretical understanding of ICT concepts.

Paper 2: Document Production, Databases, and Presentations (30% of total marks) – 2 hours 15 minutes

- Practical test covering **word processing, databases, and presentations**.
- Candidates must demonstrate practical skills in document formatting, database queries, and multimedia presentations.

Paper 3: Spreadsheets and Website Authoring (30% of total marks) – 2 hours 15 minutes

- Practical test covering **spreadsheets and web development**.
- Candidates must manipulate data using spreadsheet formulas and create web pages using HTML and CSS.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Art, Design & Technology and Computer Science: Mrs. Fay Parker
Email address:fayparker@sji-international.edu.my

VISUAL ART

What will I learn and when?

The personal response encouraged by the IGCSE Art and Design (0400) is intended to stimulate students' imagination, sensitivity, conceptual thinking, powers of observation and analytical ability. Students will develop confidence and enthusiasm in the practice of Art and Design as they gain the technical skill necessary to form, compose and communicate in two dimensions, and the ability to identify and solve problems in visual and tactile form. The study of Art and Design will lead to a wider awareness of the role

played by the visual arts in society and in the history of civilisation. It will broaden students' cultural horizons and enrich their individual experience as well as fostering their time management and organisational skills.

In Term 1 of Year 10 you will start the Coursework task, which runs until the end of Term 1 in Y11. The Exam is held throughout Term 2 of Year 11. Each component is externally assessed. Component 1 makes up 60% of the overall grade, and Component 2 makes up the remaining 40%.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Art & Design (0400)

Skills developed on the course

You will develop a range of technical skills in drawing, painting, mixed media, composition, and printmaking. A strong emphasis is placed upon using primary sources for observational drawing, which then progresses along an individual student driven thematic approach to their artwork.

How will I learn?

Styles of learning: Very practical approach to the subject. You will work on projects that foster your enthusiasm and confidence towards individual artistic practice. You will select their own topic as a starting point from which you need to explore and approach individually.

To be successful you should be:

- Inquisitive and resourceful as they will develop, refine and record ideas, as there is multiple outcomes to a common starting point
- Proactive with a willingness to build good time management skills
- Open to learning about new ways of creating art, artists, their cultural context and examining ideas from different viewpoints
- Willing to experiment and be open to developing their individual art style

How will I be assessed?

Component 1 - Coursework Portfolio is worth 60% of the overall grade.
Component 1 starts at the beginning of term 1 of Y10. You will research, develop and present a portfolio of A2 boards. The portfolio is a selection of work that demonstrates how you have explored and developed your ideas over the duration of the course and how you have met the assessment objectives. This component is externally assessed

Component 2 - Externally Set Assignment is worth 40% of the overall grade.
You begin their externally set assignment in term 2 of Y11 and choose a theme or starting point from a list supplied by Cambridge to base your artwork around. A portfolio of boards is produced as well as taking an eight-hour test over 2 days in which a final artwork is created. All work is externally assessed.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Art, Design & Technology and Computer Science: Mrs. Fay Parker
Email: fayparker@sji-international.edu.my

DESIGN & TECHNOLOGY (DT)

What will I learn and when?

In Term 1 of Year 10, you will start the Coursework task, we will provide health and safety workshops, skill building lessons around tools and machinery which will all contribute to coursework and exam content. The exams are held throughout Term 3 of Year 11.

Each exam is worth 25% and is externally marked. The coursework element is worth 50%, internally marked, and externally moderated.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Design and Technology (0445)

Skills developed on the course

- Develop creative thinking in areas relevant to design and technology
- Develop the ability to make aesthetic, economic, ethical and technical value judgements
- Design and make products, taking into consideration sustainability and the wider impact on society
- The ability to use various tools and machinery such as 3D printers, laser cutters, hand saws and more.

How will I learn?

Styles of learning: Design and Technology has a very practical approach to the subject. Students will work on projects that foster their enthusiasm and confidence towards individual artistic practice. Students will select their area of research and identify a market gap as a starting point from which they need to explore and approach individually and creatively.

To be successful you should:

- Be creative with your thinking
- Be able to apply problem-solving skills to practical and technological problems
- Develop your communication skills central to design, realisation and evaluation
- Develop your research and investigation skills

How will I be assessed?

All students will sit 2 written exams worth 25% each and will complete a coursework project worth 50%. The exams are made up of content covered through the learnings and practical skills gained through the coursework element.

Component 2 Project Coursework
50% of your overall grade - 100 marks
School-based assessment.
Internally assessed and externally moderated.

Paper 1
1 hour
25% of your overall grade - 50 marks
Externally assessed.
Questions will be based on the Common content:

- Influences on designing
- Designing principles
- Communicating designs
- Making principles
- Material classification
- Structures
- Mechanisms
- Electronics

Paper 4
1 hour
25% of your overall grade - 50 marks
Externally assessed.

Questions will be based on the Specialist option: Graphic Products

- Types of material
- Drawing techniques
- Making processes
- Product analysis
- Use of technology

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Art, Design & Technology and Computer Science: Mrs. Fay Parker
Email: fayparker@sji-international.edu.my

MUSIC

What will I learn and when?

This IGCSE Music syllabus offers you the opportunity to develop your understanding and skills, within an exciting and diverse course. As a musician, you will develop your own practical musical skills through being both a Performer and Composer. You will also develop your listening skills by studying music from the main historical periods and styles of Western Classical music, as well as more recent Popular music genres and from selected non-Western, World Music traditions. The emphasis within the syllabus is as much on developing your lifelong musical skills, in all three disciplines, to better equip you for future musical studies or for a lifelong love and understanding of Music. The skills acquired on the course promote the development of much wider skills, such as collaboration, communication, critical thinking, resilience and organisation, not just developing the student as a musician but also as a rounded academic.

Throughout the course, there will be ongoing opportunities to develop composing through unit-specific tasks, which will then be selected to be developed as part of their composing coursework element. You will develop skills in a variety of styles from Baroque through to Pop and Musical Theatre. There will also be opportunities for regular practice and performance as soloists and in ensembles within the class to develop a portfolio of work to select for your performance coursework element. This can include works selected by you, the student, in consultation with your teacher and encourages you to develop an awareness of your strengths as a performer. Although the course deals with academics and musical theory, all aspects of the course are approached practically and from the view of the contemporary musician.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE International Music (0410)

Skill developed through the course:

- You will be required to read and write traditional notation on treble, bass and alto clef and interpret key signatures, scales, intervals and chords.
- When listening to a piece of music, you will be required to perceive and critically respond to the instruments, ensembles, genres and periods, including recognition of the musical elements of rhythm, melody, harmony, structure and texture.
- You will develop skills of composition, applying a variety of compositional techniques to create your own pieces in a variety of styles.
- Develop a perceptive and critical response to the main historical periods and styles of Western music as well as music of selected non-Western traditions.
- Demonstrate an appreciation of cultural similarities and differences of music from different times and cultures.
- Gain a foundation for further study in music at a higher level.
- Develop skills in performance, which will ideally be at an Exam Board Grade 4 or equivalent standard.
- Development of wider life skills, such as co-operation, organisation and confidence.

To be successful you should:

- Have enthusiasm and enjoyment of music-making and listening.
- Be naturally inquisitive about the workings and construction of Music.
- Desire to develop your skills to become a well-rounded musician.
- Be prepared to perform on an instrument (or voice) as a soloist and in an ensemble.
- Plan to be involved in extracurricular music CCAs or activities.
- Be able to read music, or be prepared to learn the basics.
- It would be very useful to have some experience of music outside normal Years 7, 8 and 9 classroom lessons, including private tuition and involvement in extracurricular groups

How will I learn?

Learning will be done through individual and group instruction, practical music-making experiences, exploration through compositional techniques, using digital online software, and through listening to and analysing music from different times and contexts. Regular feedback and performance opportunities will support your learning journey.

How will I be assessed?

Listening 40%
Exam: Taken in Year 11 in June. Mock exams are taken in Year 11 in January
This is a written exam based on responding to a CD of musical recordings
Externally marked

Performing 30%
Two prepared performances, one individual and one ensemble, totalling 4 - 10 minutes
Internally marked and externally moderated

Composing 30%
Two contrasting compositions
Internally marked and externally moderated

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Department: Mr. Luke Hague
Email: lhague@sji-international.edu.my

PHYSICAL EDUCATION
(AS AN EXAMINED COURSE)

What will I learn and when?

- Students will develop their knowledge and understanding of the theory underpinning physical performance in a modern world.
- Students will perform in a range of physical activities, developing skills and techniques, and selecting and using tactics, strategies and/or compositional ideas.
- They will understand and appreciate the benefit of physical activity and sport for health, fitness and well-being including how to improve their own performance.

This will be taught in practical and theoretical-based classroom lessons.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Physical Education - (0413)

Skill Requirements

- Knowledge, skills and understanding of a range of relevant physical activities.
- An enjoyment of the sciences, specifically Biology.
- An ability to plan, perform and evaluate physical activities.
- An understanding of effective and safe performance.
- An understanding of the role of sport and physical activity in society and in the wider world.
- An enjoyment of physical activity.

How will I be assessed?

- AO1 - Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of the theoretical principles that underpin performance in physical activity / sport

- AO2 - Apply knowledge and understanding of the theoretical principles to a variety of physical activities / sports, including the analysis and evaluation of performance

- AO3 - Demonstrate the ability to select and perform appropriate skills to produce effective performance in practical activities

A01/A02 - The examination assesses candidates' knowledge and understanding in relation to the syllabus content. Candidates are required to demonstrate skills of description, interpretation and evaluation. The question paper has a weighting of 50% of the total marks of the qualification and uses a mix of short answer questions and structured questions. Exam length: 1 hr 45 minutes.

A03 - Coursework is worth 50% of the total marks of the qualification and each activity is marked out of 25 marks. The coursework component assesses candidates' performance in four physical activities across two different strands.

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Physical Education: James Regan
E-mail: jamesregan@sji-international.edu.my

DRAMA

What will I learn and when?

Drama is much more than acting. It is a subject that develops confident communicators, creative thinkers and effective collaborators. Students learn how to analyse complex ideas, solve problems creatively, work successfully as part of a team and present themselves with confidence in front of others.

These are skills that are highly valued by universities and employers across a wide range of careers including law, business, medicine, education, marketing, media, engineering and the performing arts.

Throughout the course, students will explore theatre from the perspectives of an actor, director and designer. They will:

- Develop vocal and physical performance skills.
- Learn how to create believable and engaging characters.
- Study and perform extracts from published plays.
- Devise original theatre from a range of creative stimuli.
- Explore staging, lighting, sound, costume and set design.
- Develop analytical and evaluative skills through reflection on their own work and professional theatre.

Specification Name and Number: Cambridge IGCSE Drama 0411 Please click on this link to read more about the details of this exciting new course, starting in 2027.
You can also view Miss Heather's presentation here.

Drama IGCSE is absolutely for you if:

- You have an interest in performing and enjoy watching theatre.
- You enjoy working as part of a team.
- You like working practically and prefer coursework to exams.
- You are creative and like to read.
- You are committed to attending rehearsals for your coursework.

How will I be assessed?

Written Examination (40%)

A 2-hour open-text examination based on one set play studied during the course.

Students answer a range of questions from the perspective of an actor, director and designer, demonstrating their understanding of how a script can be brought to life in performance.

Coursework (60%)

Students submit:

- **One individual performance** based on an extract from a published play (3 minutes maximum).
- **One group performance** based on an extract from a published play.
- **One group devised performance** created from a stimulus.
- **One written evaluative review** reflecting on the devising process and final performance.

Who should I contact for further information?
Drama Subject Leader: Heather Smith
E-mail: heathersmith@sji-international.edu.my

PSYCHOLOGY

What will I learn and when?

OxfordAQA International IGCSE Psychology covers the following topics:

Cognition and behaviour: Memory Perception Biopsychology Research methods	**Social context and Behaviour:** Communication Social influence Mental health Research methods

Specification Name and Number

International IGCSE Psychology (9218) Graded 9-1.

Skill Requirements

Psychology requires learners to demonstrate an ability to:

- Use specialist vocabulary, psychological concepts, terminology and convention to engage in the process of psychological enquiry
- Acquire knowledge and understanding of psychology, developing an understanding of self and others, and how psychological understanding can help to explain everyday social phenomena
- Understand how psychological research is conducted, including the role of scientific method and data analysis
- Present information, develop arguments and draw conclusions through a critical approach to psychological evidence, developing as reflective thinkers
- Develop an understanding of the relationship between psychology and personal, moral, social and cultural issues, and develop an understanding of ethical issues in psychology
- Develop an understanding of psychological issues, the contribution of psychology to individual, social and cultural diversity, and how psychology contributes to society.

How will I be assessed?

Paper 1 on Cognition and Behaviour is 2 hours and out of 100 marks, worth 50% of the IGCSE. Paper 2 on Social Context and Behaviour is 2 hours and out of 100 marks, worth 50%. This subject follows a linear specification; individual components may not be re-sat, although candidates can re-take the whole qualification. Assessment objectives as follows:

- AO1: Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of psychological ideas, processes and procedures.
- AO2: Apply knowledge and understanding of psychological ideas, processes and procedures.
- AO3: Analyse and evaluate psychological information, ideas, processes and procedures to make judgements and draw conclusions

Who should I contact for further information?

Head of Department: Miss Sarah Smith
Email: sarahsmith@sji-international.edu.my

ASDAN INTERNATIONAL BRONZE, SILVER AND GOLD AWARDS

What will I learn and when?

The ASDAN International Development Bronze, Silver and Gold Awards recognise personal development, recording and certificating learners' personal skills, qualities and achievements. There are different awards available: Bronze (60 hours), Silver Challenge (120 hours), Silver (120 hours) and Gold (120 hours). It is for young people of all abilities, mainly aged between 14 and 19.
Each student book contains a curriculum of challenges, divided up into themed modules covering topics such as communication, community, number handling, sport and leisure and expressive arts. Learners complete challenges to gain credits, with one credit awarded for 10 hours of activity.

Benefits and Outcomes of the ASDAN Program

- The ASDAN program helps students develop positive self-image, confidence, teamwork, organisation and interpersonal skills
- Students learn employability skills, money management, and financial literacy
- The program includes practical challenges and opportunities for students to explore their interests and lead their learning.
- Students who complete the ASDAN program receive internationally recognised certificates, which showcase key competencies and life skills

Examples of Student Activities and Success Stories

- Students organise trips and presentations, participate in internships, and engage in community work
- Success stories include students following their passions and achieving personal and professional success
- The ASDAN Awards program provides valuable experiences and empowers students to take responsibility for their learning and development.
- The program is flexible and can be tailored to meet the needs of individual students
- The ASDAN program compliments academic studies in preparing students for the future.

How will I be assessed?
Students present a portfolio of evidence of their activities. This portfolio will contain:

- Completed student book
- Evidence of challenges completed
- Planning and reviewing documents
- Record of progress
- Summary of achievement, identifying skills development
- Personal statement

Portfolios of evidence will be first assessed internally and then moderated in the UK by ASDAN

Who should I contact for further information?
Head of Department: Mr Jonny Rouse
Email: jonathanrouse@sji-international.edu.my
https://www.asdan.org.uk/about-us/

ADDITIONAL MATHEMATICS

(By Invitation only)

What will I learn and when?

Cambridge IGCSE Additional Mathematics (0606) extends the knowledge and skills developed in IGCSE Mathematics. Students explore more advanced mathematical ideas, develop fluency in algebra and learn to solve challenging problems involving several stages of reasoning.

Areas of study include functions, quadratic functions, polynomials, equations and inequalities, simultaneous equations, logarithmic and exponential functions, straight-line graphs, coordinate geometry of the circle, circular measure, trigonometry, permutations and combinations, series, vectors, and calculus.

Teaching builds from secure algebraic foundations towards more advanced techniques and their applications.

Entry Requirements and Accelerated Pathway

IGCSE Additional Mathematics (0606) is offered **by invitation only**. Invitations are extended to Year 9 students who achieve a **minimum Grade B in both their Term 3 assessment and their End-of-Year 9 examination**.

This programme forms the accelerated pathway. Students on this pathway will sit IGCSE Mathematics (0580) in Term 3 of Year 10, followed by IGCSE Additional Mathematics (0606) in Term 3 of Year 11.

Specification Name and Number

Cambridge IGCSE Additional Mathematics (0606)

Skill Requirements

The course requires a strong foundation in algebra and a willingness to persevere with challenging problems. Throughout the course, students will develop skills in:

- Manipulating algebraic expressions accurately and efficiently.
- Connecting mathematical ideas and selecting appropriate methods.
- Solving problems that require several stages of reasoning.
- Working confidently with abstract concepts and mathematical notation.
- Constructing logical arguments and justifying conclusions.
- Presenting clear, precise and well-organised solutions.
- Calculating accurately both with and without a scientific calculator.

To be successful you should:

- Have secure foundations in IGCSE Mathematics, particularly algebra.
- Enjoy mathematical challenges and be willing to explore unfamiliar problems.
- Practise regularly to develop accuracy, fluency and confidence.
- Show each stage of your working clearly.
- Revisit earlier topics and recognise how new ideas build on previous learning.
- Ask questions promptly when you encounter difficulties.
- Reflect on feedback and use mistakes to improve your understanding.
- Develop effective study habits and take responsibility for your progress.

How will I learn?

Students learn through teacher explanations, worked examples, guided practice, independent study and collaborative problem-solving. Lessons develop both understanding and fluency, with opportunities to compare methods, explain reasoning

and apply techniques in unfamiliar situations.

Regular practice is essential. Students will work on questions of increasing complexity, including problems that connect several topics. Feedback and reflection will help students identify gaps in their understanding and become more confident, independent mathematicians.

How will I be assessed?

All students take two externally assessed written examinations:

Examination	Duration	Marks	Weighting	Calculator requirements
Paper 1: Non-calculator	2 hours	80	50%	Calculators are not permitted
Paper 2: Calculator	2 hours	80	50%	A scientific calculator is required

Both papers contain structured and unstructured questions and may assess any part of the syllabus. Students must answer all questions and show all necessary working.

Candidates are eligible for grades A*–E. There is no coursework component.

Throughout the course, classwork, homework and internal assessments will help students and teachers monitor progress and identify areas requiring further support.

Who should I contact for further information??

Head of Mathematics: Mr Ananthan Seluerajah
Email: ananthan@sji-international.edu.my